INTERIM AMENDMENT

TO

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

WIRE TWISTER PLIER (WITH SIDE CUTTER)

This Interim Amendment was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized Federal agencies to use this Interim Amendment as a valid exception to Federal Specification GGG-W-340a, dated March 6, 1963.

PAGE 1

Paragraph 2.1, under "Federal Standards:" Delete in its entirety.

Paragraph 2.1: Add "Federal Specification: PPP-P-40 - Packaging and Packing of Hand Tools."

Paragraph 2.1, under "Military Specification:" Delete in its entirety.

Paragraph 2.1, under "Military Standards:" Delete "MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage."

PAGE 2

Paragraph 3.6: Delete and substitute:

3.6 Handles. Handles shall be forged from alloy steel, hardened and drawn to a Rockwell "C" value of 36-50, and shaped so as to provide a safe, comfortable handgrip.

FSC 5120

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PAGE 2 (CON.)

Paragraph 3.7: Delete and substitute:

3.7 Jaws. Jaws shall be forged from alloy steel, hardened and drawn to a Rockwell "C" value of 36-50, and shall be provided with an integral wire cutter adjacent to the joint section. The gripping surfaces of the jaws shall be scored or serrated in a manner that will improve the grip of the jaws, but not so deep or sharp that damage will occur to the lock wire being twisted. In addition to the heat treatment above, the serrated portion of the jaws and the wire cutter shall be heat treated to a Rockwell "C" value of 56-64. A wire clearance opening shall be provided between the two jaws and located between the gripping and cutting areas of the jaws. This opening shall be of a size and design which will permit the user to swiftly and easily deflect double strands of wire out of the sides of the jaws and away from the cutting edges when performing continuous (multiple) lock wiring operations. The nose design shall be as shown in figures 1 and 2 and blend with the radius of the sides of the plier in accordance with good commercial practice. The maximum permissable opening at the top of the jaws, when closed, shall be 0.010 inch. Jaw configuration known commercially as "duck billed" and "needle nosed" will not be acceptable. The wire cutter shall meet the tests as specified in 4.3.3.

PAGE 3

Paragraph 3.9.4: Delete and substitute:

3.9.4 Locking device. The wire twister shall be equipped with a slide action locking device sufficiently durable to withstand maximum usage. The sliding sleeve design of the locking device shall operate on a longitudinal axis with the handles. There shall be a 4.0 to 1 minimum ratio between the distance from the end of the jaw to the center of the rivet and the center of the rivet to the point of locking facility on the 9 inch nominal size plier. There shall be a 4.8 to 1 minimum ratio between the distance from the end of the jaw to the center of the rivet and the center of the rivet to the point of locking facility on the 12 inch nominal size plier. The locking device shall be conveniently located and capable of being operated with one hand when gripping and releasing wire. The device shall be so designed that when the plier jaws are closed, the handles must be further compressed in order to engage the lock pin. The resultant grip between the plier jaws in this locked position shall be such as to firmly and securely grip any size lockwire from 0.010 to 0.060-inch diameter. Release of the locking device shall be accomplished automatically by a spring loaded device when the handles are compressed with one hand while holding the pliers in the same hand. The locking device shall not interfere with the user's hands when performing lock wiring operations.

PAGE 4

Paragraph 3.10: After "similar to figure 1" add "and meet the dimensional requirements of figure 2."

Table I: Delete columns "B, C, D, and weight maximum."

Figure 1: Delete in its entirety and substitute figures 1 and 2.

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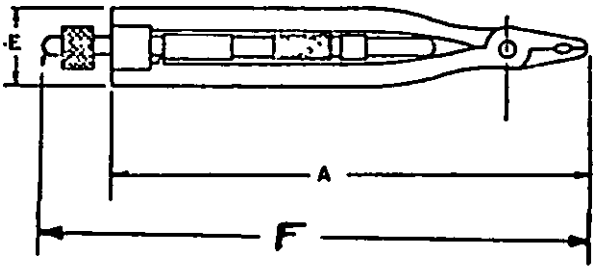


FIGURE 1. Pliers, wire twister, with side cutter.

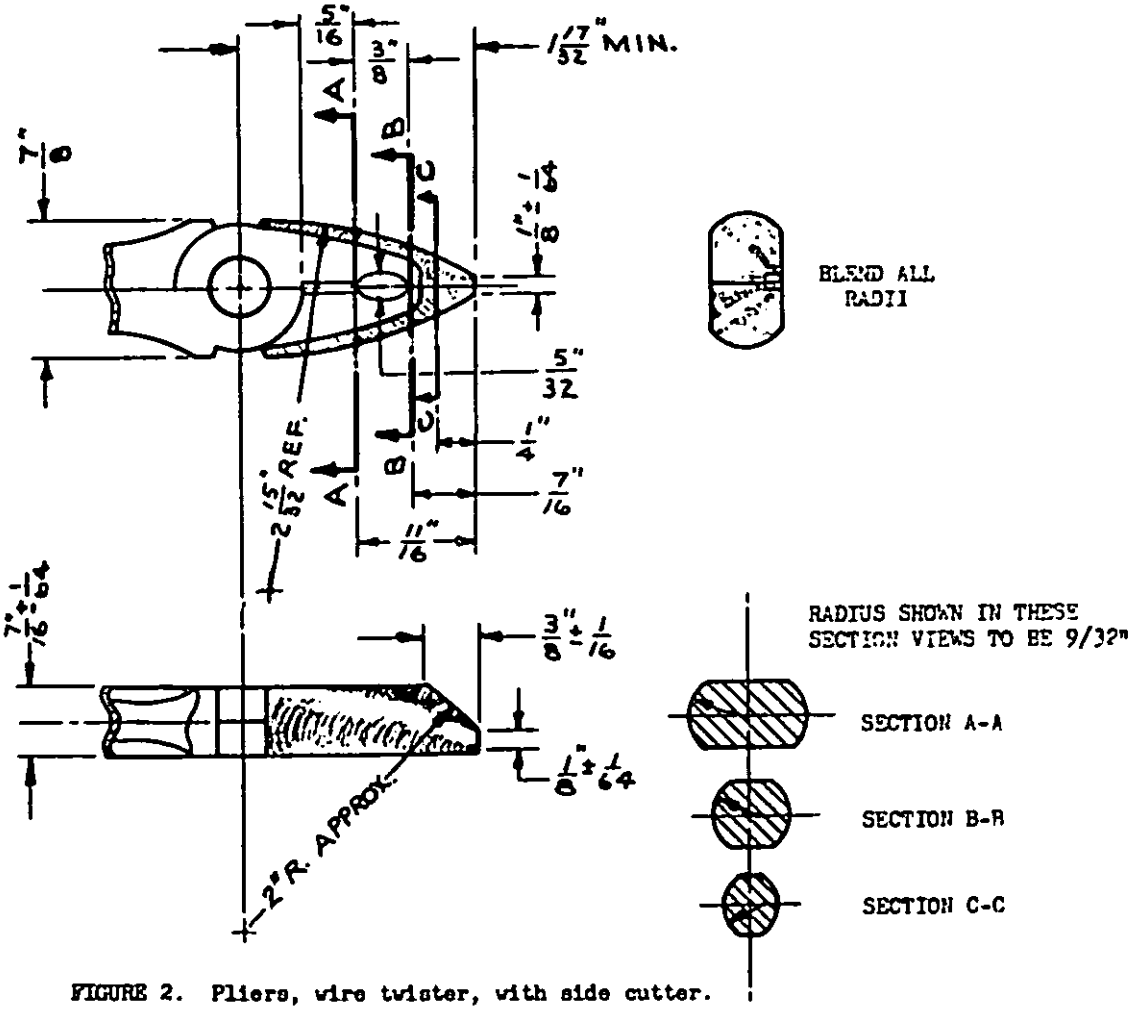


FIGURE 2. Pliers, wire twister, with side cutter.

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Paragraph 4.2.2: Delete and substitute:

4.2.2 Examination. A random sample of pliers shall be selected from each lot for examination in accordance with MIL-STD-105 at inspection level II. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 1.5 percent defective. Examination shall be conducted, as specified in table II.

Table II: Under major defects, add defect number as follows:

110 - Jaw opening at tips not as specified (see 3.6).

Paragraph 4.2.3: Fourth line, delete "L-4" and substitute "S-2".

PAGE 6

Paragraph 4.3.2: After "specified in 4.3.2.2 and 4.3.2.3" add "Handles shall be measured before and after gripping test, and shall not show more than ±1/16 inch permanent set."

PAGE 7

Paragraph 4.3.3.1: Delete in its entirety.

Paragraph 4.3.3.2: Delete and substitute:

4.3.3.2 Wire cutting test. Each wire twister shall snap cut, using hand pressure, at the joint end of the cutting edges, three pieces of 0.041 inch diameter stainless steel wire conforming to QQ-W-423 composition 316, condition A, and three pieces of 0.051 inch diameter Inconel wire as specified in 4.3.2. Excessive pressure needed to cut the wire or jaw spread exceeding the requirement of 3.7 shall be cause for rejection. If sample complies, it shall be subjected to the test of 4.3.3.3.

Figure 2: Delete in its entirety.

PAGE 8

Paragraph 4.4 and all of section 5: Delete in their entirety and substitute the following:

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the preservation, packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of PPP-P-40.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking shall be in accordance with PPP-P-40. Preservation, packaging, and packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

PAGE 8 (CON.)

Paragraph 6.1: Delete "(e)" and "(f)" and substitute the following:

(e) Applicable levels of preservation, packaging, and packing (see section 5)."

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